

Storyboard Planning

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[Tableau](#)

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Who is it for?

This dashboard is for policymakers, reform advocates, and anyone making decisions about family support programs, especially those who lack an understanding of women's lived experiences. It's also for people who are unaware of how deeply reproductive rights, emotional health, societal pressures, and the lack of structural support shape women's choices. This is meant to educate and challenge the assumptions that motherhood is simply a matter of personal preference, rather than a reflection of policy, equity, and human rights.

Why is it being built?

This dashboard is being built to raise awareness about what happens when women are stripped of the right to make decisions about their own bodies. It started with laws removing access to abortion laws created by people who often don't understand the physical, mental, and emotional weight of carrying a pregnancy. Whether driven by personal, religious, cultural, or political reasons, these decisions ignore the lived reality of what it means to give birth. Laws should protect freedom, not take it away.

Giving birth isn't just a medical process, it's deeply emotional, risky, and personal. Women can lose their lives or their sense of self in the process. And without the legal right to choose, they're forced to carry pregnancies that could destroy them especially in cases of medical danger, sexual trauma, or underage pregnancy.

Abortion isn't just about avoiding parenthood it's about survival, health, and healing. It's about acknowledging that kids shouldn't be forced to raise kids, and that no one should be legally required to sacrifice their body if it puts their life at risk. These are realities that many lawmakers don't understand.

This project exists to challenge that. It's a call for better policies, better understanding, and respect for the power and personhood of women.

What will it consist of?

This dashboard will bring together different types of analysis to show the hidden costs of motherhood, the policy gaps, and the reproductive pressure placed on women. Each section connects directly to the deeper issues explored in this

project: the emotional, financial, and physical weight of becoming a mother in a world that often takes choice and support away.

It will include:

- Fertility rate trends over time to highlight population decline and shifting family patterns.
- Public spending and childcare cost comparisons to show how little support many governments actually provide.
- Regression analysis to explore the relationship between policy support and fertility rates.
- Geospatial maps to show where support systems exist and where they don't.
- Clustering analysis to reveal which countries share similar policy profiles or challenges.
- Time series forecasting to explore what the future could look like if current trends continue.
- Supporting metrics on gender inequality, abortion rights, and maternal health risks to show how these all connect to women's autonomy and safety.

Every visual, stat, and map is chosen to make people think. To make them see. This isn't just data, it's what happens when women are pressured to give life while being given nothing in return.

When will it be used?

This dashboard is meant to support conversations that lead to change. It can be used in policymaking, public hearings, advocacy campaigns, and awareness events focused on women's rights, reproductive justice, and family support.

It's also meant to be a resource for anyone researching reproductive health, maternal outcomes, or gender equity. Whether it's shared with nonprofits, public health agencies, a classroom, a boardroom, or a protest sign, the goal is to make these patterns visible so the right people start asking better questions and making better choices.

Where will it be hosted?

This dashboard will be hosted on Tableau Public and featured in my professional portfolio at www.yarisvelacanto.com. It will also be available on GitHub, with links included on my LinkedIn and resume so it's easy to access for employers, collaborators, or anyone interested in exploring the full analysis.



Storyboard Plan (6 Story Points)

#	Story Point Title	Purpose / Message	Visuals You'll Include
1	The Cost of Motherhood: Where the Pressure Builds	Set the stage: Fertility rates are low and falling, but the pressure to have kids is rising. The real problem? Missing support.	Choropleth map (Fertility Map) + bold pull quote
2	What the Numbers Say: Fertility, Support, and the Real Cost of Care	Explore the mismatch between fertility rates and real-world support systems.	Diverging bar chart (Fertility Gap) + Bar chart (Childcare Costs)
3	Does Support Actually Impact Fertility?	Challenge assumptions about spending = higher fertility. Explore via regression + cluster analysis.	Scatterplot (Regression) + Cluster plot
4	Who's Offering Real Support?	Visualize which types of support systems are used by each cluster; it's not just about <i>how much</i> countries spend.	Grouped bar chart (Cluster Trait Profiles)
5	Time Series: Where Is Fertility Headed?	Show long-term trends in Japan, Korea, and the U.S. Support is rising in some places, but fertility isn't. Trends are structural, not random.	3 charts: Fertility over time, Public spending over time, Decomposition of Japan's fertility
6	Still Carrying the Weight: Where the Support Ends, the Burden Continues	Final synthesis and reflection. Highlight key takeaways and limits. It's not just about money, it's about pressure, autonomy, and what we expect from women.	Emoji icon summary of findings, limitations list, "What's next" checklist, and a bold insight block

Story Points

1 Story Point Title: *The Cost of Motherhood: What They Don't Want to Talk About*

Message:

Start with the truth: women are being pushed to have more kids but in a world that's refusing to back them up. This isn't just about birth rates or policy it's about what kind of pressure is being placed on people to reproduce under systems that don't protect or support them. This opening sets the tone. Who this project is for, and what's really at stake.

Visuals:

- A choropleth fertility map showing where the pressure is highest
- A paragraph intro from your "Who" and "Why" sections
- Optional: A bold quote/stat ("Over a third of countries are now below 1.5 births per woman")

2 Story Point Title: *What the Numbers Say: Fertility vs. Support*

Message:

This is where the cracks start to show. I compared fertility rates to the kinds of support governments actually provide: childcare, parental leave, healthcare. The question was simple: do women get the help they need to raise a family?

Spoiler: The gap is real. And growing. Even countries that offer support on paper aren't making it work in practice.

Visuals:

- Diverging Bar: Fertility Rate vs. Average
- Bar Chart: Childcare Costs (ages 0-2)
- Short guiding text block with questions like:
 - Are women being asked to do more with less?
 - Is support enough to make motherhood possible?

3 Story Point Title: *Does Support Actually Impact Fertility?*

Message:

I thought the more support a country gives, the more likely people are to have kids. But when I ran the regression, the data didn't back it up. The R^2 value was basically zero.

That shook me a little. It meant something deeper was going on: fear, identity, stigma, abortion access, pressure. Things the model couldn't measure. So I stepped back and changed my approach. I moved to clustering to explore patterns, not just lines.

Visuals:

- Regression scatterplot: Public Spending vs. Fertility
- R^2 annotation or text callout
- Quick insight box:
 - What I expected
 - What I found
 - Why I shifted to a new method

4 Story Point Title: Who's Offering Real Support?

Message:

Once the regression flopped, I looked closer at how support is actually structured. Instead of just measuring how *much* countries spend, I asked *how* they support parents: cash benefits, tax breaks, early education, childcare access.

Clustering helped me see patterns. Some countries were spending big and still getting low returns. Others were doing more with less. Support alone didn't explain the outcomes but the system behind it did.

Visuals:

- Cluster Trait Profile (horizontal grouped bars, 3 clusters)
- Color-coded policy traits by type
- Cluster summaries:
 - ● High Fertility, Low Support
 - ● Low Fertility, Modest Support
 - ● Support-Rich, Low Return

5 Story Point Title: Time Series: Where Is Fertility Headed?

Message:

Zooming into Japan, Korea, and the U.S., I asked: are fertility rates bottoming out or still falling? The charts only told part of the story. I ran time series models to find out whether these trends were just a blip or baked into the system.

The answer: in Japan and Korea, the decline is structural. Support increased, but fertility didn't rebound. The U.S. looked different, less spending, slower decline. That raised new questions about culture, not just policy.

Visuals:

- Line Chart: Fertility Rate (Japan, Korea, U.S.)
- Line Chart: Public Spending (% of GDP)
- Time Series Decomposition Plot (Japan): trend, seasonal, residual

6 Story Point Title: Still Carrying the Weight: Where the Support Ends, the Burden Continues

Message:

After pulling everything together from policy gaps to fertility trends and how countries cluster it became clear: this isn't just a numbers issue. The systems aren't working, and the pressure on women isn't easing.

Fertility is still falling. Support isn't reaching far enough. And in many countries, women are still expected to carry the weight alone. This isn't just a dashboard, it's a reflection of a bigger truth: motherhood is being asked for, demanded even, without real backup.

Visuals:

- Icon-based summary of key takeaways (support ≠ fertility, pressure vs. help)
- Bulleted limitations (data gaps, correlation ≠ causation, scope)
- Text box for "Next Steps" (more cultural data, track policies, refine models)
- Pull quote or bold callout tying it back to the project's message:
"It's not just about subsidies it's about survival, choice, and how motherhood is valued."

Bonus Task Part 1: Blog Post

UX/UI Feedback – Reproductive Pressure Storyboard

As a UX/UI designer, I approached the design of this storyboard with the same principles I would use in any product or experience: clarity, flow, accessibility, and emotional resonance. Here's a breakdown of the choices I made and where I think the design lands strongest:

Overall Structure & Flow

I treated each story point like a chapter, intentionally ordered to walk the viewer through a narrative that starts with emotional context, builds through

data exploration, and ends with reflection and insight. The layout is linear, but each section also functions as a standalone insight for viewers who might skim rather than follow the full path.

The visual and text balance was key. I avoided crowding story points with too many visuals and kept chart types consistent within each frame. This intentional predictability supports comprehension.

Visual Consistency

I stuck with Tableau's default theme but made small adjustments for alignment and spacing where needed. Chart titles are conversational but informative, and I used iconography and color intentionally to group insights (e.g., cluster profiles, limitation flags). My goal wasn't to overwhelm with color but to guide attention.

Each visual uses consistent axis scaling and formatting to make cross-chart comparisons easier. For instance, I used a centered zero axis in diverging bar charts and consistent decimal formatting across the support trait visuals.

Accessibility & Readability

Font size was tested for readability, especially for longer story point summaries. I minimized jargon and avoided overly technical phrasing unless it was central to the insight. The visuals are labeled clearly and support keyboard navigation (important for screen reader compatibility when viewed online).

I also structured the written content using hierarchy and spacing titles, bolded key points, and short paragraphs to help the reader scan while still getting the full message.

Emotional Design & Tone

Because the subject matter is sensitive fertility, motherhood, policy gaps I wanted the visuals to feel human, not just clinical. The first story point ("The Cost of Motherhood") sets that tone, and I tried to keep it grounded throughout. The visuals are clean, not flashy, because I wanted the story to feel thoughtful and credible rather than performative.

Bonus Task Part 2: Blog Post

Blog Title:

How Clustering Helped Me Spot Policy Gaps in Fertility Support

What it's about:

This short blog post breaks down how I used clustering in my Reproductive Pressure project to uncover something that averages couldn't explain. Some countries were spending a lot on family benefits, but still seeing low fertility

rates. I used clustering to go beyond totals and group countries by the *type* of support they offered cash, childcare, education, and tax relief.

That's where the gaps really showed up.

Even in the highest-spending group, fertility outcomes stayed low. The blog explains how I built the clusters, what patterns stood out, and why structure matters more than size when it comes to policy.

Where it lives:

It's included in my GitHub repo under the [blog/](#) folder and linked in the README.